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BEYOND THE UPSWING

Is the current exuberance in the economy a momentary surge, or does it signal a structural reboot that could extend into the next few quarters? And what more needs to be done to keep the momentum going? Here's what the Board of India Today Economists (BITE) think

Q The RBI has said the economy is at its Goldilocks moment. Is the country in a strong phase of growth? How sustainable is the trend?

DHARMAKIRTI JOSHI

The country is currently in a stronger-than-expected growth phase. With an 8.0 per cent print in the first half of the current fiscal year, growth has surpassed expectations. The main drivers have been private consumption, manufacturing and services activity, prompting upward revisions in forecasts from various stakeholders, including the RBI.... We estimate that a 6.5-7 per cent growth trajectory is sustainable for India.

SAMIRAN CHAKRABORTY

India's post-COVID growth recovery has been exceptionally strong, with average GDP growth of last five years exceeding 8 per cent, despite multiple global headwinds.... We acknowledge that the recent growth trends have been supported by timely cyclical fiscal and monetary stimulus through tax and rate cuts, which might taper off next year. But still the momentum in the economy and further emphasis on deregulation-driven supply side reforms should be able to support a 7 per cent-plus growth next year.

ASHIMA GOYAL

It is Goldilocks since growth is high and inflation is low—an unusual combination, especially in view of the external shocks we are facing. The reversal of the pandemic-induced as well as last year's cyclic contraction shows policy has the capability to counter external and domestic shocks to smooth growth—this is the best warranty of a sustainable growth trend.

SOUMYA KANTI GHOSH

India is indeed in a strong and well-balanced growth phase, with stable macroeconomic conditions, moderating inflation, robust domestic demand, and a resilient financial sector. This growth momentum reflects